AMAN – Response to the Product Owner's Review

Android · Sprint 0 follow-up · Prepared by iRoid Solutions · 12 October 2026

> **In short:** everything in the review can be built. Most of what KAHF Guard and Qustodio do depends on their own server and parent app, so several items below need AMAN's server, which is part of Phase 1. A few things are blocked by Android itself for every app, including KAHF and Qustodio. For those, the parent gets an alert.

Feature	Can we do it?	Main limitation
1. Harmful website blocking	Yes Categories need our server	Until our server is live, the parent's category choices apply in browsers only.
2. Allow / Block list	Yes	As in KAHF, "allow only" mode applies to browsers.
3. Safe Search and keyword blocking	Yes	A few apps (some games) hide their search box from Android.
4. VPN detection	Yes, already working	New VPN-like apps are added to our list as they appear.
5. DNS / network bypass	Yes	Phones sharing the child's hotspot are not filtered.
6. Remote control during Internet Pause	Yes, needs our server	A phone with no signal gets the resume once it reconnects. An offline code covers this.
7. Tamper protection	Yes Some items alert only	Safe Mode, factory reset and Guest user can't be stopped on a normal setup.
8. UI/UX, cloned apps, Arabic	Yes	Blocking cloned apps still has to be tested on Samsung and Xiaomi.

1. Harmful website blocking

WHAT WE WILL DO

- No local VPN. Filtering uses Android's Private DNS, the same approach as KAHF Guard. **Done.**
- Typing a site's IP address, or using similar tricks, is blocked in browsers. **Done.**
- Coverage was measured by us rather than taken from vendors' claims, including KAHF's and Arabic sites. Details are in our separate coverage report.
- Qustodio-style categories, each set to **Allow**, **Alert me** or **Block**. This needs AMAN's own DNS server and a professional (licensed) website category list that includes Arabic sites.
- NextDNS is a faster way to start, but it offers far fewer categories than Qustodio.

LIMITATIONS

- Until our server is live, apps outside browsers get one fixed filter for everyone.
- The filter blocks whole websites, not single pages.
- "Alert me" can sometimes fire for a site that loaded in the background of another page. Repeated alerts for the same site will be grouped together.

2. Allow / Block list

WHAT WE WILL DO

- The same experience as KAHF, with no limit on the number of sites.
- The "pictures not loading" problem will be removed.
- Lists will be saved on our server, so clearing the app's data won't lose them. Clearing data will also be locked while protection is on.

LIMITATIONS

- As in KAHF, whose own screen says "only the sites below open in browsers", the "allow only" mode applies to browsers. Other apps are not limited to the list.

3. Safe Search and in-app keyword blocking

WHAT WE WILL DO

- Safe Search forced on Google and Bing, plus restricted mode on YouTube.
- Searches for harmful words are blocked inside apps such as YouTube, TikTok, Instagram, Snapchat, X and the Play Store, as well as in browsers.
- Arabic and English word lists, plus the parent's own words, with no 30-word limit.

LIMITATIONS

- Some apps, mostly games, hide their search box from Android, so it can't be read. The same applies to KAHF.
- We read only what is typed into search and text boxes, never messages or page content.
- Whether YouTube's restricted mode is forced depends on which filter is chosen.

4. VPN detection and blocking

WHAT WE WILL DO

- Already working, and broader than a fixed list: **every** VPN app on the phone is detected and closed when opened.
- If the child tries to connect a VPN, the request is cancelled. If one connects anyway, the phone is locked to Settings until it is switched off.
- New: Tor and browsers with a built-in VPN, such as Opera, added under a single "Block VPN & Tor apps" switch, like KAHF.

LIMITATIONS

- A brand-new app that hides traffic without being a VPN can get through until we add it to our list. Our server can send list updates without an app update.

5. DNS and network bypass

WHAT WE WILL DO

- Today we alert the parent. Next we will **block**, as KAHF does: the Private DNS setting, the browsers' "Secure DNS" setting and the network reset page close as soon as the child opens them.
- The parent can unlock them with a PIN, from the parent app or with an emergency code.
- Websites that offer other DNS services, and proxy websites, are blocked by the filter.

LIMITATIONS

- A phone or laptop using the child's hotspot is not filtered.
- Fully locking these settings needs the optional "Device Owner" setup. Otherwise they are protected by AMAN's Accessibility permission, which Feature 7 protects in turn.

6. Internet Pause: remote control while paused

WHAT WE WILL DO

- AMAN keeps its own connection during a pause, so the parent can resume the internet from their phone.
- A pause can be set for a fixed time and ends by itself.
- An emergency code from the parent app works even when the child's phone is offline. KAHF offers the same.
- Option: Qustodio's approach, which blocks all apps except basic ones instead of cutting the internet. It needs no VPN at all.

LIMITATIONS

- Needs our server and the parent app.
- If the child's phone has no signal at all, a remote resume arrives when it reconnects. The emergency code covers this case.
- The current pause briefly uses a VPN, only while paused.
- Still to be confirmed on a device: that messages from the parent app arrive while the pause is on.

7. Tamper protection (core requirement)

WHAT WE WILL DO

- Uninstall, "Force stop" and "Clear data" are locked while protection is on.
- Any setting that could switch AMAN off closes as soon as the child opens it: AMAN's permissions, Private DNS, VPN, developer options, adding users and reset options. Google Play allows this for parental-control apps.
- Parent PIN on the phone, approval from the parent app, and an offline emergency code.
- If the phone stops reporting, the parent is alerted within minutes.
- Optional "Device Owner" setup for maximum protection.

LIMITATIONS

- On a normal setup, Android doesn't let any app, including KAHF or Qustodio, stop **Safe Mode**, a **factory reset** or switching to a **Guest user**. The parent is alerted instead. The Device Owner setup blocks all three, but it needs the phone to be reset when AMAN is installed.
- Android 17 adds an "Advanced Protection" setting that turns off apps like AMAN. We will block access to it and alert the parent.
- Some phone brands close background apps. We will provide a setup guide and alert the parent.
- To be confirmed on Samsung and Xiaomi phones.

8. UI/UX, cloned apps and Arabic

WHAT WE WILL DO

- The child's age becomes optional.
- Cloned apps are already detected in four different ways.
- "Routines" renamed to "Modes" in Arabic. The app will fully support Arabic and right-to-left layout, using the labels from Abdelrahman.

LIMITATIONS

- Blocking cloned copies, not just detecting them, still has to be tested on Samsung Dual Messenger and Xiaomi Dual Apps.
- Only the Device Owner setup can stop clones from being created in the first place.

Decisions we need from you

1. **Website categories:** build AMAN's own DNS server with a professional category list (our recommendation), or start faster with NextDNS and fewer categories.
2. **Internet Pause:** keep cutting the internet (a VPN only while paused), or switch to Qustodio's approach of blocking apps (no VPN at all).
3. **Device Owner setup:** should we offer it as an optional "maximum protection" setup?
4. **Alerts:** confirm that an alert may show the website's name. We never store full page addresses.

Platform facts above were checked against Android's own source code, Google Play policy, and the public documentation of KAHF Guard, Qustodio and NextDNS. Items marked "to be confirmed" will be tested on Samsung and Xiaomi phones in the next phase.